

Literacy Skills: Reading and Writing, Grade 10

Open

ELS20

This course is designed to help students strengthen essential reading and writing skills, providing them with the extra literacy support they need in order to graduate. Students will read informational, graphic, and literary texts, with a focus on locating information, identifying main ideas and supporting details, building vocabulary, and consolidating skills in the application of key comprehension strategies. The course will also help students develop core learning strategies.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 9, Academic or Applied, or a Grade 9 English LDCC (locally developed compulsory credit) course

READING SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Reading for Meaning:** read and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of contemporary literary, informational, and graphic texts, using a range of strategies to construct meaning;
- 2. Understanding Form and Style:** recognize a variety of text forms, text features, and stylistic elements and demonstrate an understanding of how they help communicate meaning;
- 3. Reading With Fluency:** use knowledge of words and cueing systems to read fluently;
- 4. Reflecting on Reading Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as readers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Reading for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- 1.1** read a variety of self-selected and teacher-assigned literary, graphic, and informational texts representing a variety of cultures and perspectives (e.g., literary: *short stories, multi-cultural poetry, song lyrics, narratives, Aboriginal stories*; graphic: *graphic novels, comic books, student agendas, cellphone bills*; informational: *newspaper and magazine articles, pamphlets, brochures, flyers, owner's manuals*)

Teacher prompts: “What have you been reading this week? Record this in your reading log.” “What types of texts do you enjoy reading?”

Reading for Different Purposes

- 1.2** identify a variety of purposes for reading texts commonly used in everyday life (e.g., *a magazine article, to gather information on a topic; the telephone book, to locate a local business; a map, to locate different local attractions; a cover letter, to use as a model for writing a similar type of letter*)

Teacher prompts: “Why would you read a review of a new CD or video game?” “What different reasons might a custodian, a supervisor, and a lawyer have for reading a memo from their company’s management?”

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- 1.3** identify and use appropriate reading comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading to understand teacher-assigned and self-selected texts (e.g., *preview text to make predictions about the content; skim for main ideas and scan for specific words; highlight or make margin notes to interact with the text; reread sections to clarify meaning and check understanding*)

Teacher prompts: “When you come to a section you do not understand, what options do you have?” “How can personal knowledge and prior experience help you make sense of this text?” “What can you learn by reading over your highlighted areas and margin notes?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- 1.4** identify and record important ideas and supporting details in literary, graphic, and informational texts (e.g., *use highlighting or sticky notes to identify the main ideas in a magazine article; create bookmarks to track character development in a novel; use a chart to track the nutritional information on food labels*)

Teacher prompt: “What main ideas would you include in a five-sentence summary of this article?”

Interpreting Texts

- 1.5** interpret texts, identifying and explaining the overt and implied ideas and information they convey (e.g., *chart explicit information about a character in a short story; differentiate between*

fact and opinion in a magazine article or report; explain what details in the biography of a celebrity led them to like or admire the person)

Teacher prompts: “What conclusions does this information lead you to?” “What does the ending tell you about the character that you weren’t expecting?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

- 1.6** extend understanding of texts by connecting and comparing the ideas in them to their own knowledge, experience, and insights; to other texts; and to the world around them (*e.g., compare their own preferences for particular authors, genres, and topics with those of peers and suggest some reasons for the similarities and differences; in a small group, explain how their personal values and perspectives influence their responses to and interpretations of texts; compare various print and online resources to determine how different authors treat the same topic*)

Teacher prompts: “What other texts have you read on this topic?” “Can you think of a real-life parallel to the events in this story?”

Analysing Texts

- 1.7** analyse texts in terms of the information, ideas, issues, or themes they explore, examining how various aspects of the texts contribute to the presentation or development of these elements (*e.g., explain how the conflict encountered by the main character in a short play contributes to the theme of the play; explain the use of buzz words, slogans, and incomplete comparisons in various print and online advertisements; identify descriptive words, actions, and dialogue that helped them get a clear picture of the characters in a short story and explain why; identify the elements that helped them understand an explanation in a science, geography, or business text*)

Teacher prompt: “Do the text and visual elements in an advertisement communicate similar or different aspects of the advertiser’s message? Could the visual elements stand alone? Could the text stand alone?”

Evaluating Texts

- 1.8** evaluate the effectiveness of texts using evidence taken from the text to support the evaluation (*e.g., explain why a newspaper report does or does not help them understand a local community issue*)

Teacher prompts: “Are the visuals in the trouble-shooting guide clear and easy to follow? Do they work well with the text?” “Are the facts in the opinion piece relevant to the author’s main point?”

Critical Literacy

- 1.9** identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in texts and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (*e.g., identify the narrator’s attitude towards his or her topic or characters and the language that conveys that attitude; identify perspectives that are missing from a story and suggest reasons for the omission*)

Teacher prompt: “Whose perspective is missing from the story? Are you able to infer what that perspective might be? What conclusions might you draw from this absence?”

2. Understanding Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Text Forms

- 2.1** identify a variety of characteristics of literary, informational, and graphic text forms and explain how they help communicate meaning (*e.g., the arrangement of elements on the front page of a newspaper; the positioning of ads in relation to the articles in a magazine; the use of setting and dialogue in a short story or novel; the use of stanza breaks and rhyme in a song or poem; the use of the 5 W’s plus “How” in a news article; the use of chronological order in a biography or autobiography; the use of ascending or descending order of importance in a persuasive argument; the use of tables to convey information in a textbook*)

Teacher prompts: “What pattern of organization would seem most logical for a biography?” “What patterns do you see repeated in news reporting?”

Text Features

- 2.2** identify a variety of text features and explain how they help communicate meaning (*e.g., diagrams, charts, maps, and illustrations help to clarify ideas in informational texts; text boxes, bullets, and sidebars highlight or extend ideas in magazine articles and textbooks; changes in font size and weight help the reader locate information when skimming or scanning the text; italics are used to indicate titles of books and works of art; titles, subtitles, and graphics identify topics and clarify information in manuals*)

Teacher prompts: “What text features are most helpful in this brochure?” “How does the layout focus your attention on certain parts of the front page?” “Why is the table of contents an important element in a text?”

Elements of Style

2.3 identify a variety of elements of style in texts and explain how they help communicate meaning and enhance the effectiveness of the text (*e.g., identify descriptive language in an editorial and explain how it helps create a mood; identify connecting words and explain how they clarify the sequence in a set of instructions; explain how precise technical words strengthen the message in an article about health or safety; identify the explicit comparison being made in a simile and explain how it adds to meaning*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some concrete details the author used to create a vivid picture of the setting?” “How does a comparison to something familiar help the reader?”

3. Reading With Fluency

By the end of this course, students will:

Reading Familiar Words

3.1 read and automatically understand most words in a variety of reading contexts (*e.g., words from grade-level texts; words used in personal and peer writing; words used regularly in discussion and posted on word walls; words in shared, guided, and independent-reading texts; terminology and phrases used in school-related documents*)

Teacher prompt: “Which words have we been focusing on in our word wall?”

Reading Unfamiliar Words

3.2 predict and/or determine the meaning of unfamiliar words using different types of decoding strategies, including context cues, visual aids, and reference materials (*e.g., read ahead in the passage to find or deduce the meaning of an unfamiliar word or phrase; use root words, prefixes, and suffixes to determine the meaning of specialized vocabulary; use accompanying illustrations, diagrams, and charts to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words and phrases in a textbook; use print and electronic dictionaries, thesauri, and reference texts to clarify the meaning and pronunciation of antonyms, synonyms, homophones, homonyms, specialized language, and commonly confused words*)

Teacher prompts: “What options do you have when trying to read an unfamiliar word?” “What are some helpful strategies to use?”

Reading With Fluency

3.3 read aloud, with expression and confidence, a variety of teacher-assigned and self-selected texts, adjusting reading strategies and reading rate to match the form and purpose for reading (*e.g., use changes in intonation, dramatic pauses, and variations in pace to heighten suspense when reading a horror story; rehearse and read, “in role”, a fictional character’s monologue or a famous person’s memorable speech; participate in choral reading with appropriate emphasis and reading rate*)

Teacher prompt: “Have you read this over to yourself first? Which words or phrases do you think you should emphasize?”

4. Reflecting on Reading Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

4.1 identify a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after reading; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify steps they can take to improve as readers (*e.g., identify familiar and new strategies to revisit or explore in the future*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategy do you use if you do not understand the text?” “What do you do when you are confused by what you have read?” “How does preparing a list of questions to answer help you find information while you are reading?” “What strategies do you use to help you recall information?”

Interconnected Skills

4.2 explain how their skills in listening, speaking, writing, viewing, and representing help them make sense of what they read (*e.g., explain how seeing a video or TV demonstration of a procedure can help them follow instructions in a manual*)

Teacher prompts: “How could writing a summary of an opinion piece you have read help you understand the piece better?” “How does listening to someone else read help you become a better reader?” “How does a Think/Pair/Share help you understand written text?”

WRITING SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Developing and Organizing Content:** generate, gather, and organize ideas and information to write for an intended purpose and audience;
- 2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style:** draft and revise their writing, using a variety of informational, literary, and graphic forms and stylistic elements appropriate for the purpose and audience;
- 3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions:** use editing, proofreading, and publishing skills and strategies, and knowledge of language conventions, to correct errors, refine expression, and present their work effectively;
- 4. Reflecting on Writing Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as writers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful at different stages in the writing process.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Developing and Organizing Content

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Topic, Purpose, and Audience

- 1.1** identify the topic, purpose, audience, and appropriate writing form for specific writing tasks (e.g., *a poster to promote a favourite musical artist to the class; a letter to the editor expressing a point of view about a current issue in the community; a study sheet summarizing the information on traffic signs in a driver's manual*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the purpose of your writing – to inform? to persuade? to entertain?” “What form will best suit your purpose? Why?” “Who is the intended audience for your writing? How will your target audience influence your writing?”

Generating and Developing Ideas

- 1.2** generate and focus ideas for potential writing tasks, using a variety of strategies and resources (e.g., *watch a short video clip related to a topic before reading a news article about the topic; in a small group, brainstorm and discuss possible approaches to a topic; identify key words to narrow a topic for an Internet search; use graphic organizers such as a fishbone diagram or T-chart to explore and connect ideas*)

Teacher prompts: “What approaches to this topic are possible?” “What ideas were emphasized in the video?”

Research

- 1.3** locate and select information to support ideas for writing, using a variety of strategies and print and electronic sources (e.g., *use an electronic catalogue in the library or an Internet search engine to locate information from textbooks, encyclopaedias, magazines, CD-ROMs, and websites; use highlighting, note making, paraphrasing, and summarizing to gather and record relevant information; record sources used and information gathered in a form that makes it easy to understand and retrieve*)

Teacher prompts: “What sources of information have you already used?” “What key words are you using for your search?” “What information have you found so far?”

Classifying Ideas

- 1.4** sort and classify ideas and information for their writing in a variety of ways that allow them to manipulate information and view their data from different perspectives (e.g., *use cue cards for each of the 5W's to classify information for a biography; use a graphic organizer to show relationships between and among different types of information on a topic; in a small group, use headings to group data collected from an online source*)

Teacher prompts: “What labels would you use for each of the parts of the graphic organizer?” “What connections can you see between different types of information in the graphic organizer?” “How might this organizer help you as you plan your writing?”

Organizing Ideas

- 1.5** identify and order main ideas and supporting details and group them into units that could be used to develop a multi-paragraph piece of writing, using a variety of strategies and organizational patterns (e.g., *organize information by topic and subtopic using teacher-and-student-generated headings; use index cards to organize information from a documentary in chronological order; complete a Venn diagram to show similarities and differences between two cultural perspectives on a topic*)

Teacher prompts: “What organization seems most logical for this topic?” “What headings will you use?”

Reviewing Content

- 1.6** determine whether the ideas and information gathered are relevant to the topic and sufficient for the purpose, and do more planning and research if necessary (e.g., *assess the accuracy of information by comparing it with information from another source; use a graphic organizer to explain their material in a teacher conference, and ask for feedback to identify gaps; use a set of teacher-and-student-generated guiding questions to assess the breadth and depth of the information gathered*)

Teacher prompts: “How do you know when you have enough information?” “How current are the sources you consulted?” “Does the information you have provide a complete overview of the topic?” “What other sources could you use to expand your research?” “What information did you find that you did not use? Why?”

2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

- 2.1** write texts of different lengths and for different purposes and audiences using a variety of forms (e.g., *a summary of a magazine article for a class report; a short narrative about a celebrity or superhero for the school magazine; a supported opinion piece presenting their point of view on a community or global issue for a class assignment*)

Teacher prompts: “What different forms could you choose for this celebrity profile?” “How does the purpose of your writing affect the choice of form?”

Voice

- 2.2** establish an identifiable voice in their writing, adapting language and tone to suit the form, audience, and purpose for writing (e.g., *use formal language in a short essay describing the theme of a graphic novel; use informal language and the first person in a letter to a friend; use colloquial language in an e-mail to a friend describing an incident at work*)

Teacher prompts: “Is the language appropriate to the topic and audience?” “Does your own personality come across in the writing? How?”

Word Choice

- 2.3** use appropriate descriptive and evocative words, phrases, and expressions to make their writing clear, vivid, and engaging for the reader (e.g., *use a variety of adjectives and adverbs to create a detailed, specific impression; use concrete images to create a vivid picture of a setting; use inclusive, bias-free language to show respect for readers*)

Teacher prompts: “What is another way of saying this?” “How could we get across the same idea in a way that is respectful to all potential readers?”

Sentence Craft and Fluency

- 2.4** write complete sentences that communicate their meaning clearly and accurately, varying sentence type, structure, and length to suit different purposes and making logical transitions between ideas (e.g., *vary the word order in sentences for emphasis and interest; use transition words to link paragraphs in a letter; combine sentences to eliminate wordiness and sharpen the focus*)

Teacher prompts: “Where do your sentences work together nicely?” “Would combining these sentences make your meaning clearer?”

Point of View

- 2.5** explain how their own beliefs, values, and experiences are revealed in their writing (e.g., *identify words and phrases in their writing that reveal their own mood or attitude; explain why they have included or omitted references to a particular point of view in their writing*)

Teacher prompts: “Have you used inclusive and non-discriminatory language in your writing?” “What do these short, sharp sentences tell us about your feelings on the subject?”

Preparing for Revision

- 2.6** identify the strengths of their writing and elements that need improvement, selectively using feedback from the teacher and peers, with a focus on teacher-specified criteria (e.g., *use feedback from a partner to identify missing ideas or details and unnecessary information; respond to teacher questioning to identify ideas that do not follow logically or that are awkwardly sequenced*)

Teacher prompts: “What aspects of your own writing do you consider successful?” “What areas of your writing did you identify as needing some improvement?”

Revision

- 2.7** make revisions to improve the content, clarity, and interest of their written work, using a variety of teacher-modelled strategies (e.g., *insert additional information and/or remove unnecessary words or phrases to clearly link ideas in a supported opinion piece or report; insert appropriate transition words to signal time changes in a report on a contemporary issue; add descriptive language to help the audience visualize a scene; complete a student-and-teacher-generated checklist to ensure that all assigned criteria have been met*)

Teacher prompts: “Does your writing include sufficient and accurate details to convey your intended meaning?” “What is missing, when we look over the report? What do you need to add in order to make it complete?”

3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

Spelling Familiar Words

- 3.1** use knowledge of spelling patterns and rules, a variety of resources, and appropriate strategies to spell familiar words correctly (e.g., *use knowledge of word patterns, word families, root words, prefixes, suffixes, and syllabication to check spelling; use a variety of spelling references, such as dictionaries and spell checkers, to flag possible errors; use spelling and abbreviation forms appropriate to different media and audiences, such as texting language*)

Teacher prompt: “How does knowing root words help you improve your spelling?”

Spelling Unfamiliar Words

- 3.2** use available print and electronic resources and a variety of strategies that involve understanding sound-symbol relationships, word structures, word meanings, and generalizations

about spelling to spell unfamiliar words correctly (e.g., *recognize and look up specialized vocabulary, unfamiliar words, and words that deviate from regular spelling patterns; check an electronic dictionary and other online resources for the correct spelling of abbreviations and technical terms; highlight keywords to be checked to improve spelling accuracy*)

Teacher prompt: “Which words will you definitely need to check in a dictionary before handing this in?”

Vocabulary

- 3.3** build vocabulary for writing by confirming word meanings and reviewing word choice using a variety of resources and strategies, as appropriate for the purpose (e.g., *use peer- and self-assessment to confirm whether or not words look and sound right in the context; use bilingual or first-language dictionaries to confirm the meaning and correct usage of new vocabulary; use various print and online resources such as word walls, glossaries, technical dictionaries, and thesauri to check and refine word choices*)

Teacher prompts: “How do you know which form of the word to choose?” “How do you know the meaning of the word from the thesaurus?”

Punctuation

- 3.4** use punctuation correctly and appropriately to communicate their intended meaning (e.g., *use commas to separate items in a list; insert quotation marks to indicate dialogue or use of sourced materials; use semi-colons to separate two or more principal clauses in a sentence; use apostrophes to show possession or contraction; use colons to introduce a list; use appropriate end punctuation to express moods such as inquiry, surprise, hesitation*)

Teacher prompts: “Where do you need commas in this sentence?” “How do you show that this is someone speaking?”

Grammar

- 3.5** observe accepted grammar conventions, using parts of speech and word order correctly to communicate their meaning clearly (e.g., *make subjects agree with verbs, and pronouns agree with antecedents; use pronouns in the objective case after prepositions: “John gave it to him and me”; “To whom it may concern”*)

Teacher prompt: “If your subject is plural, what is the matching plural form of the verb you have chosen to use?”

Proofreading

3.6 proofread and correct their writing using guidelines developed with peers and the teacher (*e.g., use student-and-teacher-generated questions to self-edit throughout the writing process; during a student-teacher conference, show evidence of multiple and continuous revision*)

Teacher prompt: “What errors did you catch when you read the piece aloud?”

Publishing

3.7 use a wide range of appropriate presentation features, including print and script, fonts, graphics, and layout, to improve the clarity and coherence of their written work and to engage their audience (*e.g., ensure that written information is legible and reasonably neat; word-process the final copy of a short narrative; add appropriate graphics such as charts, pie graphs, or tables to a report to expand on key ideas in the text; use appropriate fonts to indicate titles, headings, and subheadings*)

Teacher prompts: “What can you do to make the presentation of your work more attractive?” “How can you finish it to show how much effort you have put into this?”

Producing Finished Works

3.8 produce pieces of published work to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations (*e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriateness of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Teacher prompt: “Have you checked your work against the checklist outlining the requirements of the writing task?”

4. Reflecting on Writing Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

4.1 describe a variety of strategies they used before, during, and after writing; explain which ones they found most helpful; and identify specific steps they can take to improve as writers (*e.g., identify strategies that helped them improve their writing; identify skills that were particularly important for completing a specific writing project*)

Teacher prompts: “What form and style of writing do you prefer? Why?” “How do you decide what information is important and should be included in the final text?”

Interconnected Skills

4.2 identify skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, viewing, and representing and explain how the skills help them write more effectively (*e.g., explain how brainstorming and conferencing help them develop and structure their writing; explain how reading has familiarized them with a range of models to use in writing*)

Teacher prompt: “How does reading a variety of texts help you as a writer?”

Portfolio

4.3 select pieces of writing that they think reflect their growth and competence as writers and explain the reasons for their choice (*e.g., writing that meets teacher-identified criteria as well as personal criteria*)

Teacher prompts: “What piece of writing best reflects your current understanding of what makes a good research report?” “How do these pieces show your growth in understanding different cultures and perspectives?” “Why have you chosen this piece to revise and publish in an anthology?”